

Chapter 173-1

Liang Shi never expected to trend on hot search at such a critical juncture.

And it was with the hashtag #TrueAndFakeHeiress#.

This wasn't beneficial for Liang Xinran at all.

After "Let's Go Right Now" aired, her reputation had been very good. As long as she maintained her current popularity and reputation, resources would definitely come looking for her after the variety show finished filming. Moreover, her management contract was under the media company that Liang Xinzhou had acquired.

Liang Xinzhou had also reassured Liang Shi that he would keep an eye on Liang Xinran.

If Liang Xinran had bought this hot search just to destroy the reputation she had only just restored, that would be too brainless.

This was practically a case of killing one thousand enemies while losing eight hundred of your own.¹

Liang Shi first scanned through the comments under the trending topic.

It was obvious that people were still stirring up trouble. Several marketing accounts had compiled Liang Xinran's previous Weibo posts and photos to compare the living circumstances of Liang Shi and Liang Xinran.

This truly drummed up a wave of hatred against Liang Shi.

[No wonder no one could dig up this girl's background. Turns out she's a fake heiress.]

[Tsk tsk, how can she be so self-righteous after stealing someone else's life? Is she really that shameless?]

[If I were her, I'd immediately leave the industry, okay? How does she have the nerve to compete with the real heiress for family and resources?]

[I genuinely feel sorry for Liang Xinran. My silly beauty, sob sob sob.]

[.....]

In the story netizens imagined, Liang Shi was the pampered heiress who got everything she wanted. For all these years, she had been an idle good-for-nothing in a wealthy family, yet still enjoyed the care of her parents and older brothers. Meanwhile, Liang Xinran had suffered harsh treatment in some godforsaken backwater;² lost her parents early, and depended on her seriously ill grandmother for survival. Because of lack of money, she couldn't even attend university.

The contrast was too stark.

Netizens condemned Liang Shi one after another, even denying her acting skills in the process.

This also triggered a wave of refund requests for "Journey of the Heart."

Even the person in charge of "Lingering Light" called Chang Hui, beating around the bush to ask whether this matter was true.

Chang Hui could only give a vague response.

Chang Hui had been in this industry for many years and had some connections. But after asking many journalist friends, no one knew where this information had leaked from, nor who had bought the hot search.

They could only trace the marketing account that initially broke the news to someone who used to be an anti-fan of Zhao Ying.

If the leak was because Liang Shi was close to Zhao Ying, how did that person know about the matter between Liang Shi and Liang Xinran?

And they even had the guts to expose it, making it trend within an hour.

This was definitely organized.

Using Liang Shi as a target to get revenge on Zhao Ying—the motive made sense, but the logic didn't.

Just as Liang Shi was still searching for the reason, Xu Qingzhu's side had already made progress. The final target was identified—Sun Chengcheng.

Liang Shi: "....."

This information came from Lu Jiayi telling Xu Qingzhu. Lu Jiayi was able to find this out thanks to her fiancée Fu You, who was a top student who had graduated with a degree in information technology. She directly hacked into the Weibo account that broke the news, and without any moral qualms, invaded the other party's computer to obtain chat records, then identified the person by searching accounts.

Of course, Lu Jiayi didn't tell Xu Qingzhu all this.

Lu Jiayi only gave the information to Xu Qingzhu. When Xu Qingzhu asked how she found out, she hesitated for two seconds before saying: "Fu You had someone look into it."

"Thanks," Xu Qingzhu had no intention of asking more. "I'll have Liang Shi treat you both to dinner another day."

Lu Jiayi smiled lightly: "It was nothing."

Meanwhile, on the other side of the city, Liang Xinran had just finished recording a new episode of "Let's Go Right Now."

She had landed in Haizhou less than an hour ago. From morning to night, she had been busy the entire time and hadn't even had a hot meal.

Having finally returned to Haizhou, she went directly to a restaurant under Dongheng's name.

But just as the food arrived and she picked up her chopsticks, before she could even grab a bite, she heard a stern shout: "Liang Xinran!"

Liang Xinran's hand trembled, and the food fell onto the table. She looked up toward the doorway.

Liang Xinhe, full of fury, walked toward her. He slapped one hand on the table and said coldly: "I really underestimated you."

Liang Xinran's brows furrowed slightly. Her eyes carried fear as she lightly pressed her lips together: "Second Brother... what are you talking about?"

"Still pretending?" Liang Xinhe scoffed. "A-Shi has already left the Liang family. She's not using the Liang family's resources now, and she hasn't threatened your position as the Liang family's Third Miss. Why must you drive her to extinction?"

Liang Xinran: "?"

"I don't understand." Liang Xinran looked confused. "Second Brother, what do you mean?"

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1. A Chinese idiom meaning a pyrrhic victory—winning but suffering severe losses in the process. ⇐
 2. The original Chinese phrase "雞不生蛋鳥不拉屎" literally means "a place where chickens don't lay eggs and birds don't shit"—a colorful expression describing an extremely remote, desolate, and underdeveloped place. ⇐